

Computer Vision – Lecture 3

Image Processing II

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Course Outline

- Image Processing Basics
 - Image Formation
 - Linear Filters
 - Gradient Filters and Edge Detection
 - Structure Extraction
- Segmentation
- Object Recognition and Categorization
- Deep Learning Approaches for Vision
- 3D Reconstruction

Topics of This Lecture

- Non-linear Filters
 - Median Filter
- Multi-Scale representations
 - How to properly rescale an image?
- Filters as templates
 - Correlation as template matching
- Image gradients
 - Derivatives of Gaussian



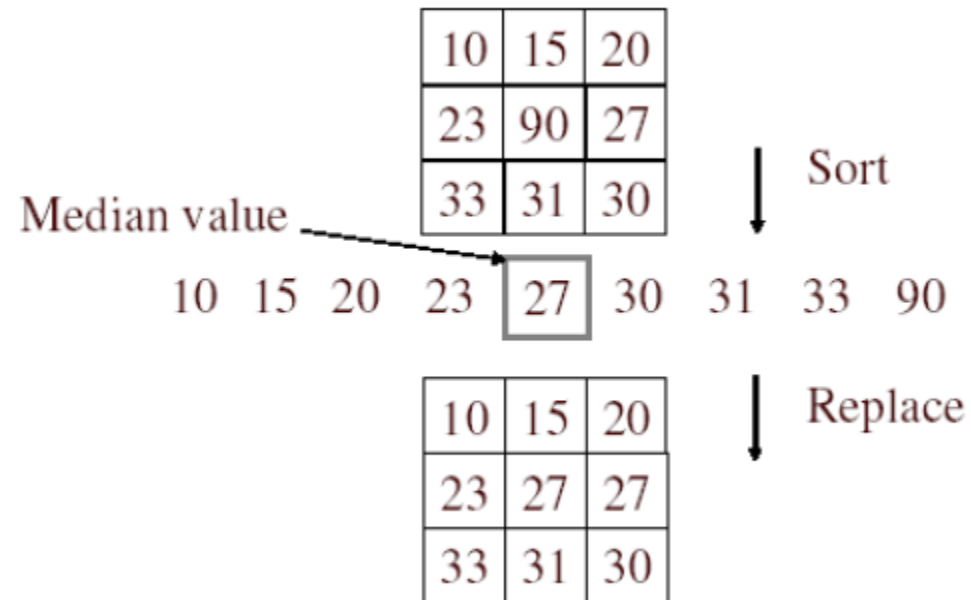
Non-Linear Filters: Median Filter

- Basic idea

- Replace each pixel by the median of its neighbors.

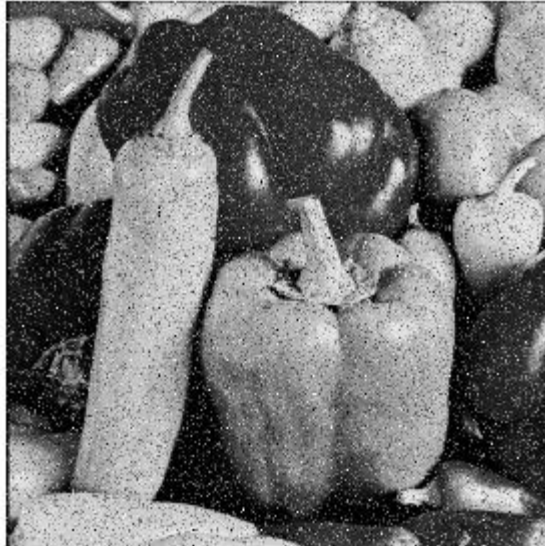
- Properties

- Doesn't introduce new pixel values
- Removes spikes: good for impulse, salt & pepper noise
- Linear?

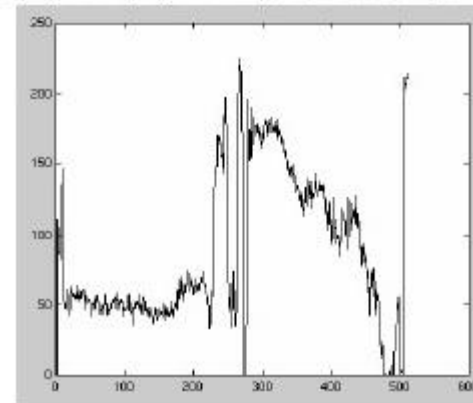
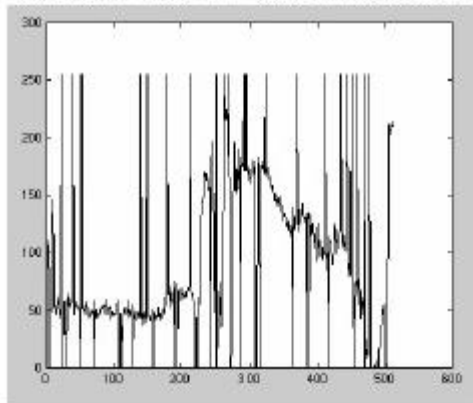


Median Filter

Salt and
pepper
noise



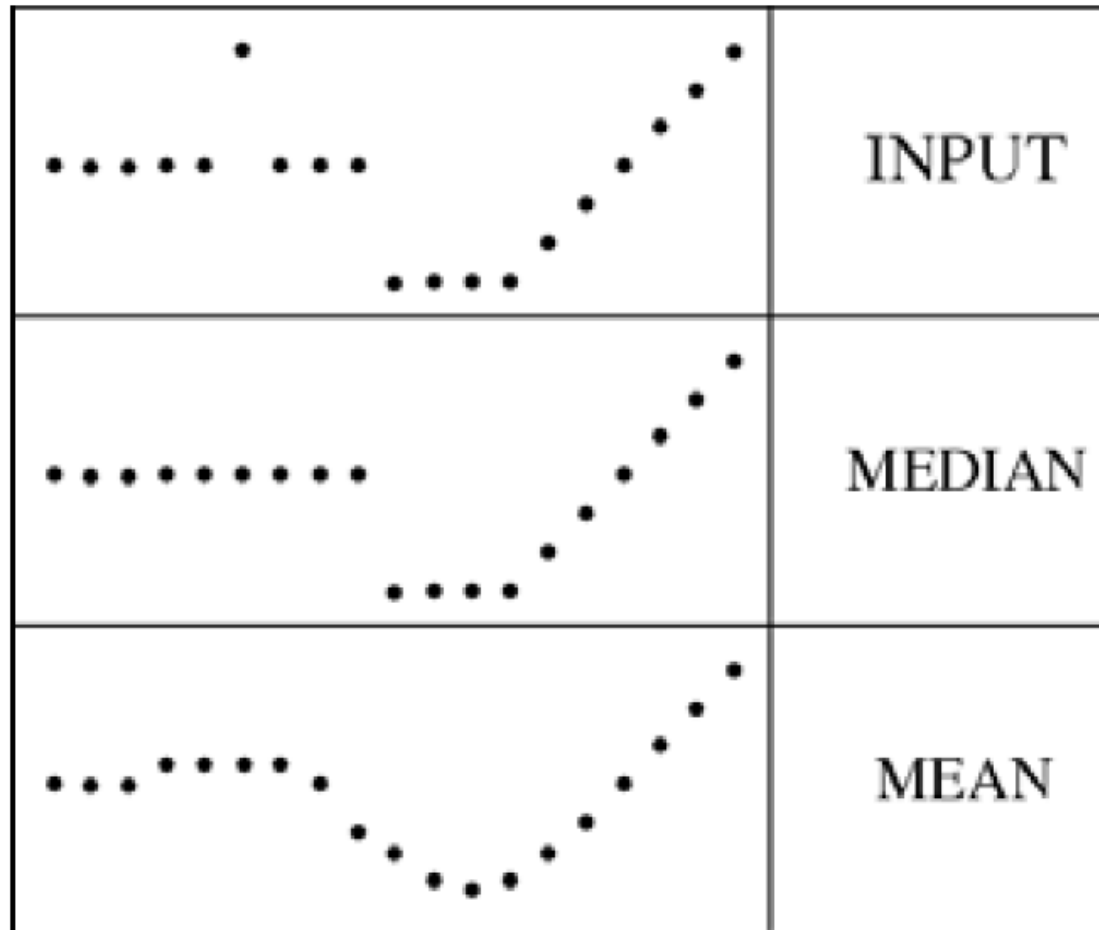
Median
filtered



Plots of a row of the image

Median Filter

- The Median filter is **edge preserving**.



Median vs. Gaussian Filtering

3x3

5x5

7x7

Gaussian



Median



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Motivation: Fast Search Across Scales

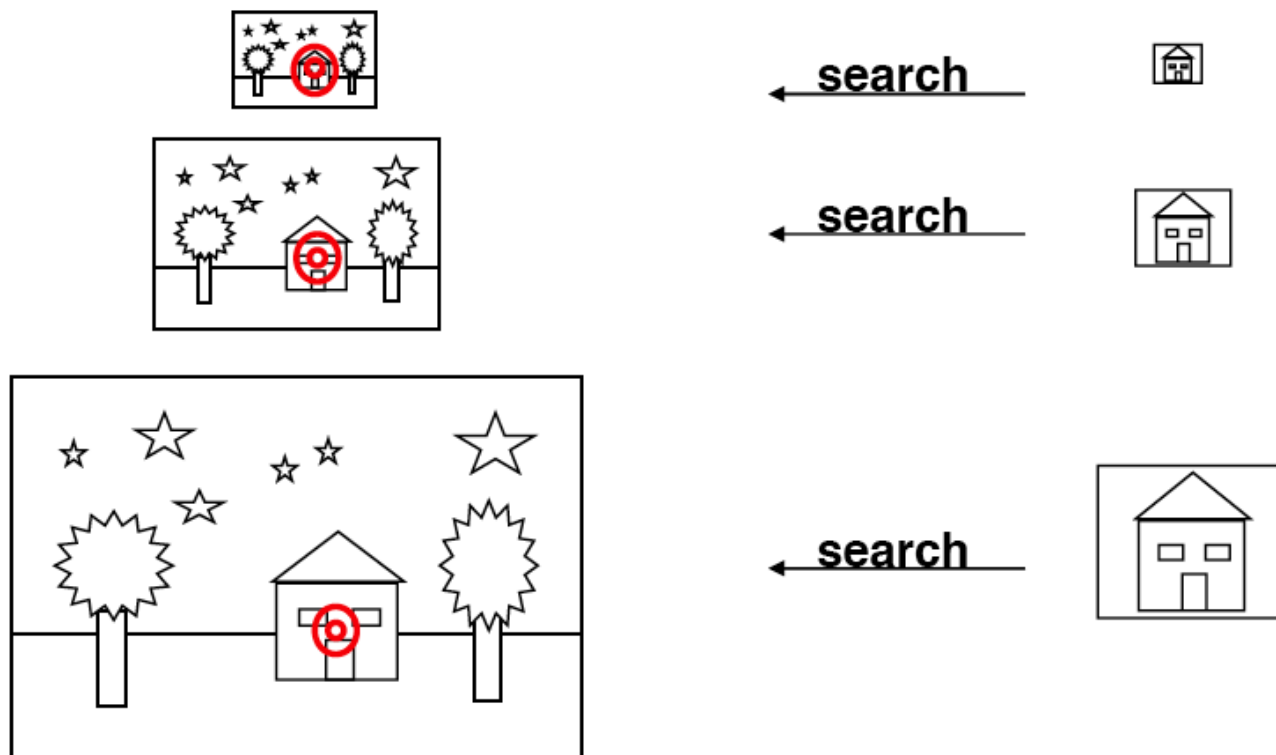
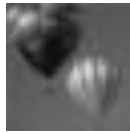


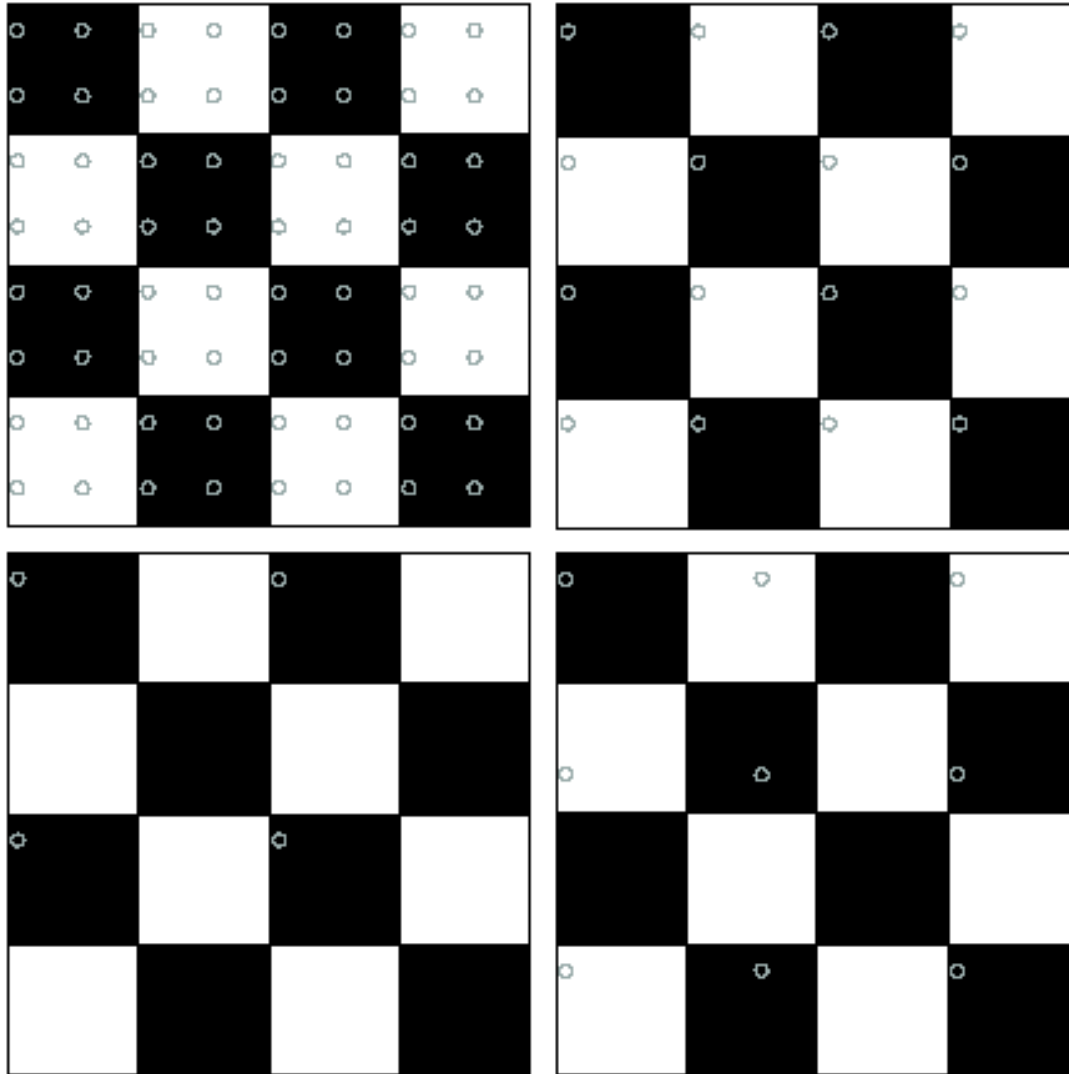
Image Pyramid

Low resolution



High resolution

How Should We Go About Resampling?



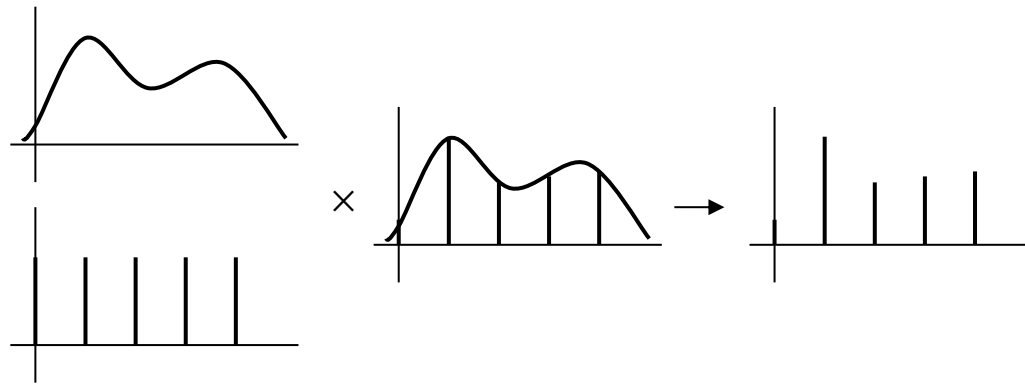
Let's resample the checkerboard by taking one sample at each circle.

In the top left board, the new representation is reasonable. Top right also yields a reasonable representation.

Bottom left is all black (dubious) and bottom right has checks that are too big.

Fourier Interpretation: Discrete Sampling

- Sampling in the spatial domain is like multiplying with a spike function.

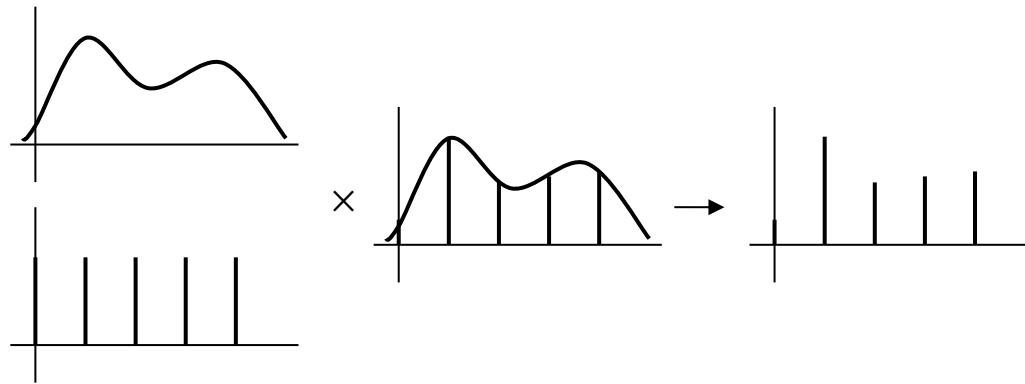


- Sampling in the frequency domain is like...

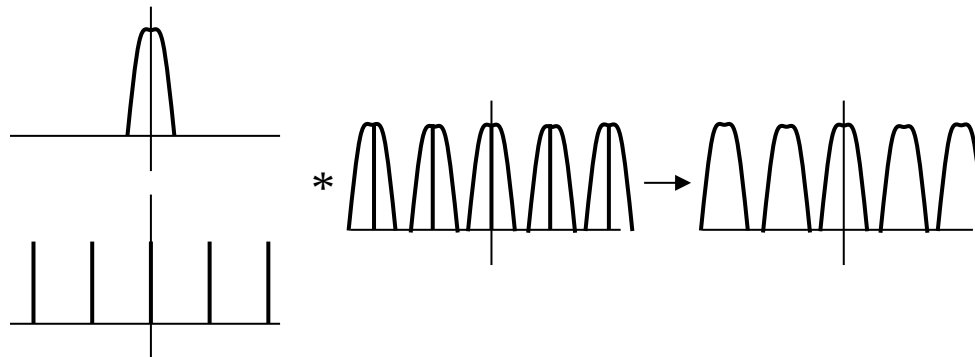
?

Fourier Interpretation: Discrete Sampling

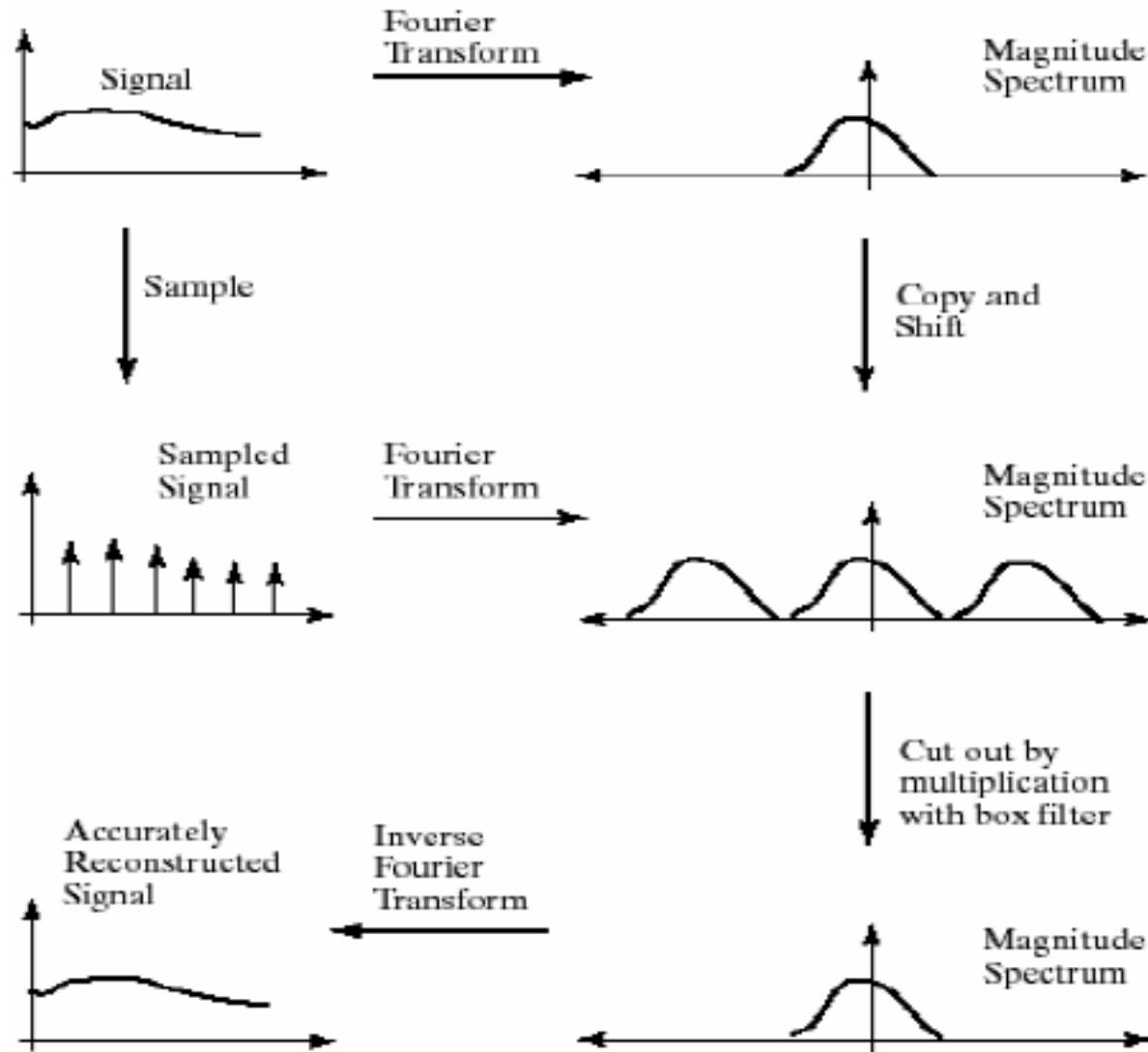
- Sampling in the spatial domain is like multiplying with a spike function.



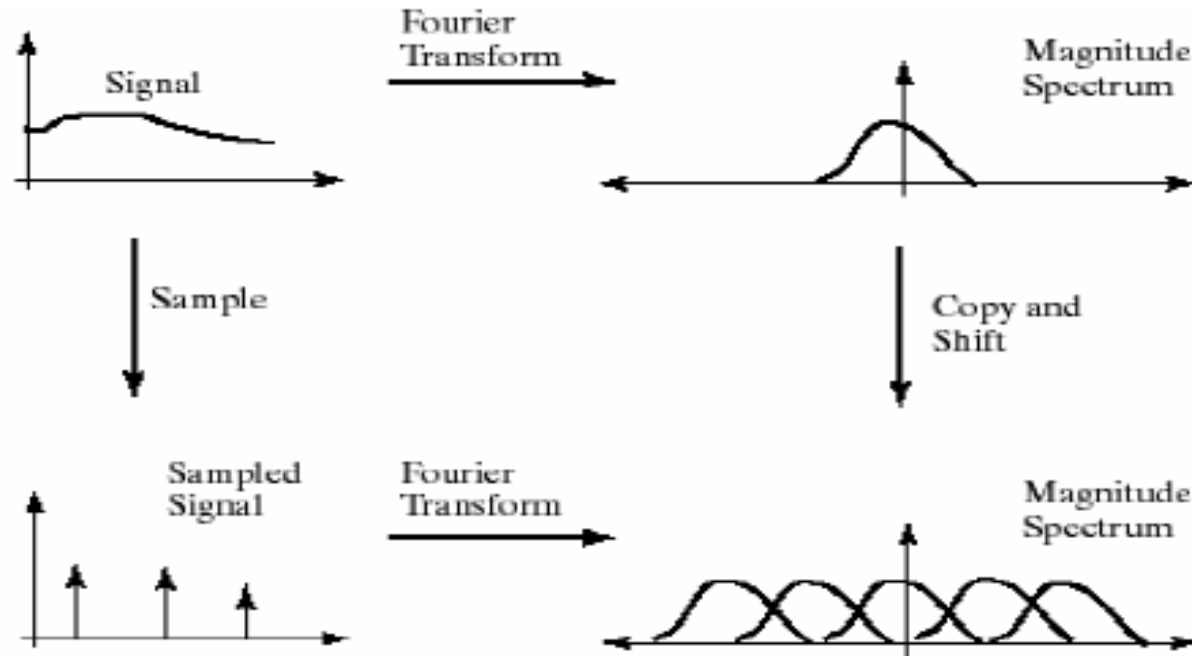
- Sampling in the frequency domain is like convolving with a spike function.



Sampling and Aliasing



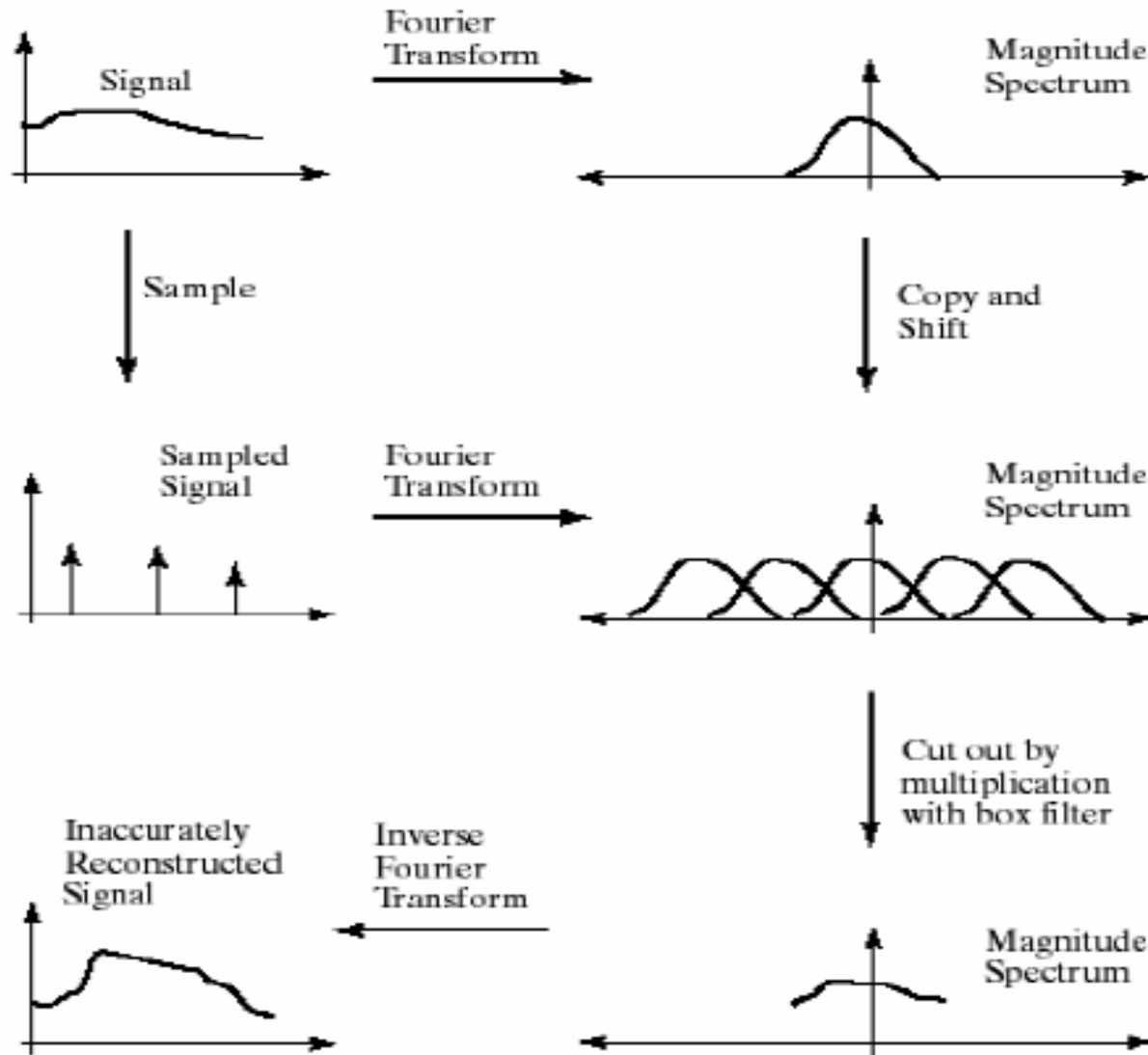
Sampling and Aliasing



- **Nyquist theorem:**

- In order to recover a certain frequency f , we need to sample with at least $2f$.
- This corresponds to the point at which the transformed frequency spectra start to overlap (the **Nyquist limit**)

Sampling and Aliasing

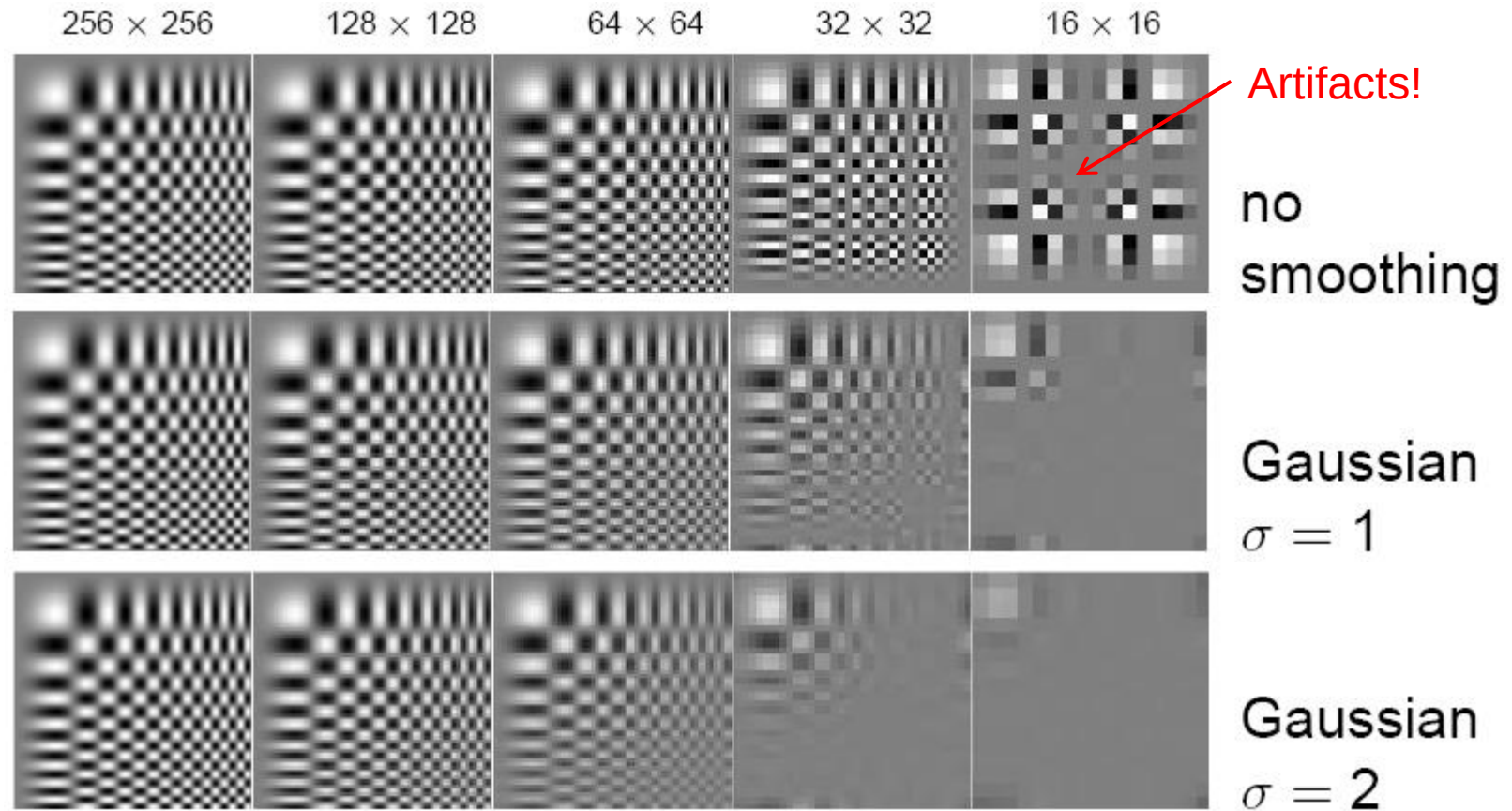


Aliasing in Graphics



Disintegrating textures

Resampling with Prior Smoothing



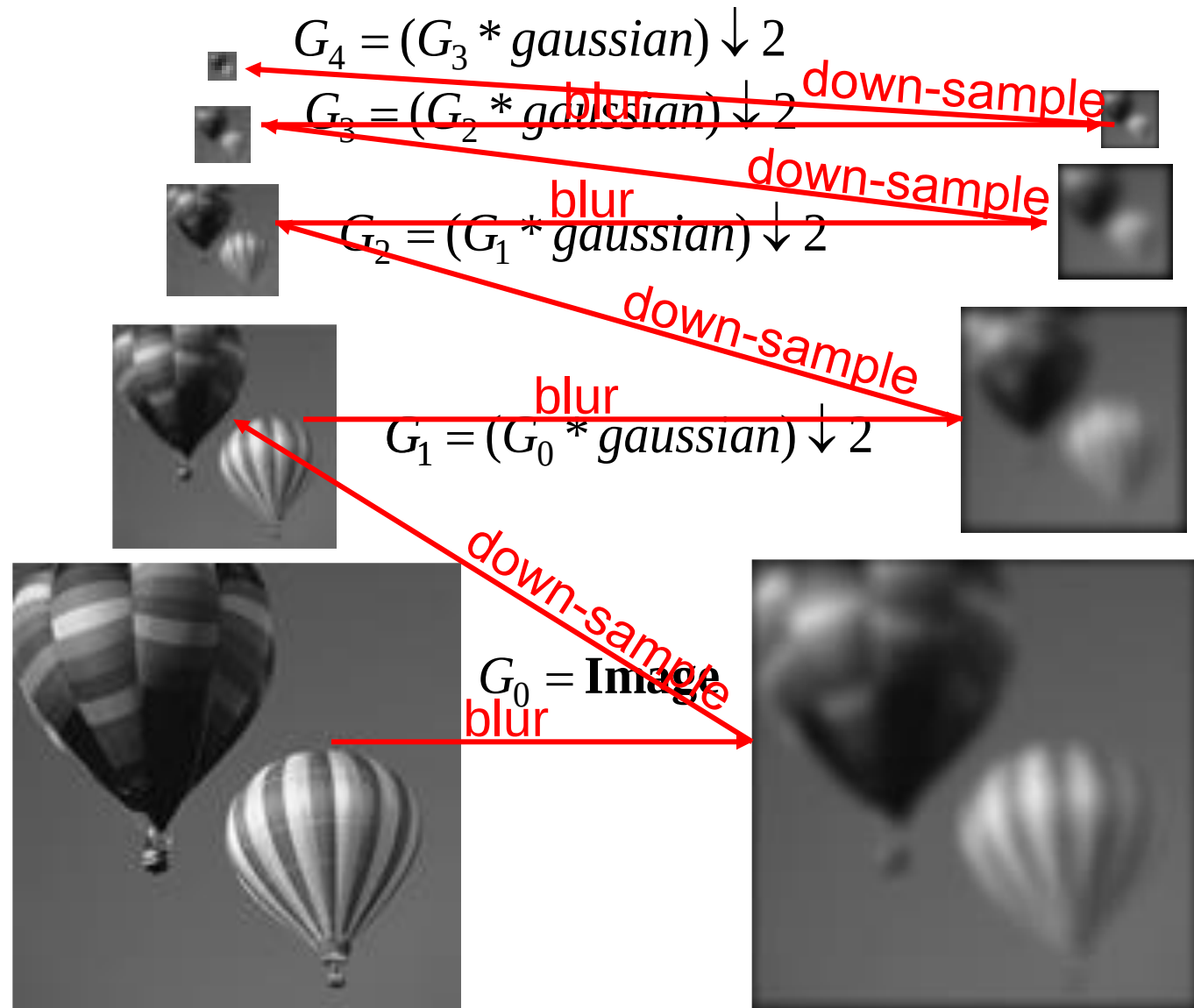
- Note: We cannot recover the high frequencies, but we can avoid artifacts by smoothing before resampling.

The Gaussian Pyramid

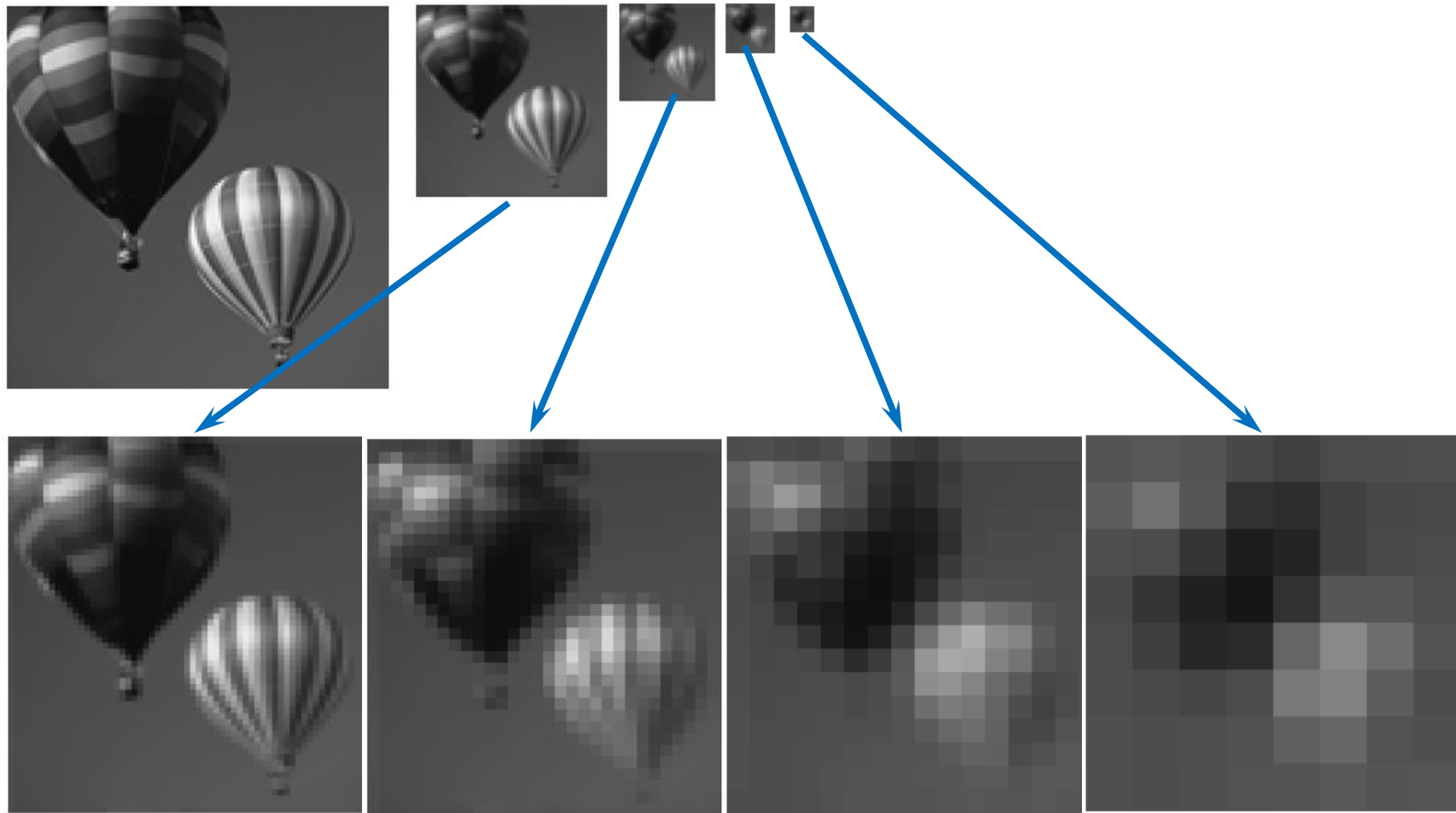
Low resolution



High resolution



Gaussian Pyramid – Stored Information



Summary: Gaussian Pyramid

- Construction: create each level from previous one
 - Smooth and sample
- Smooth with Gaussians, in part because
 - a Gaussian*Gaussian = another Gaussian
 - $G(\sigma_1) * G(\sigma_2) = G(\sqrt{\sigma_1^2 + \sigma_2^2})$
- Gaussians are low-pass filters, so the representation is redundant once smoothing has been performed.
 - ⇒ There is no need to store smoothed images at the full original resolution.

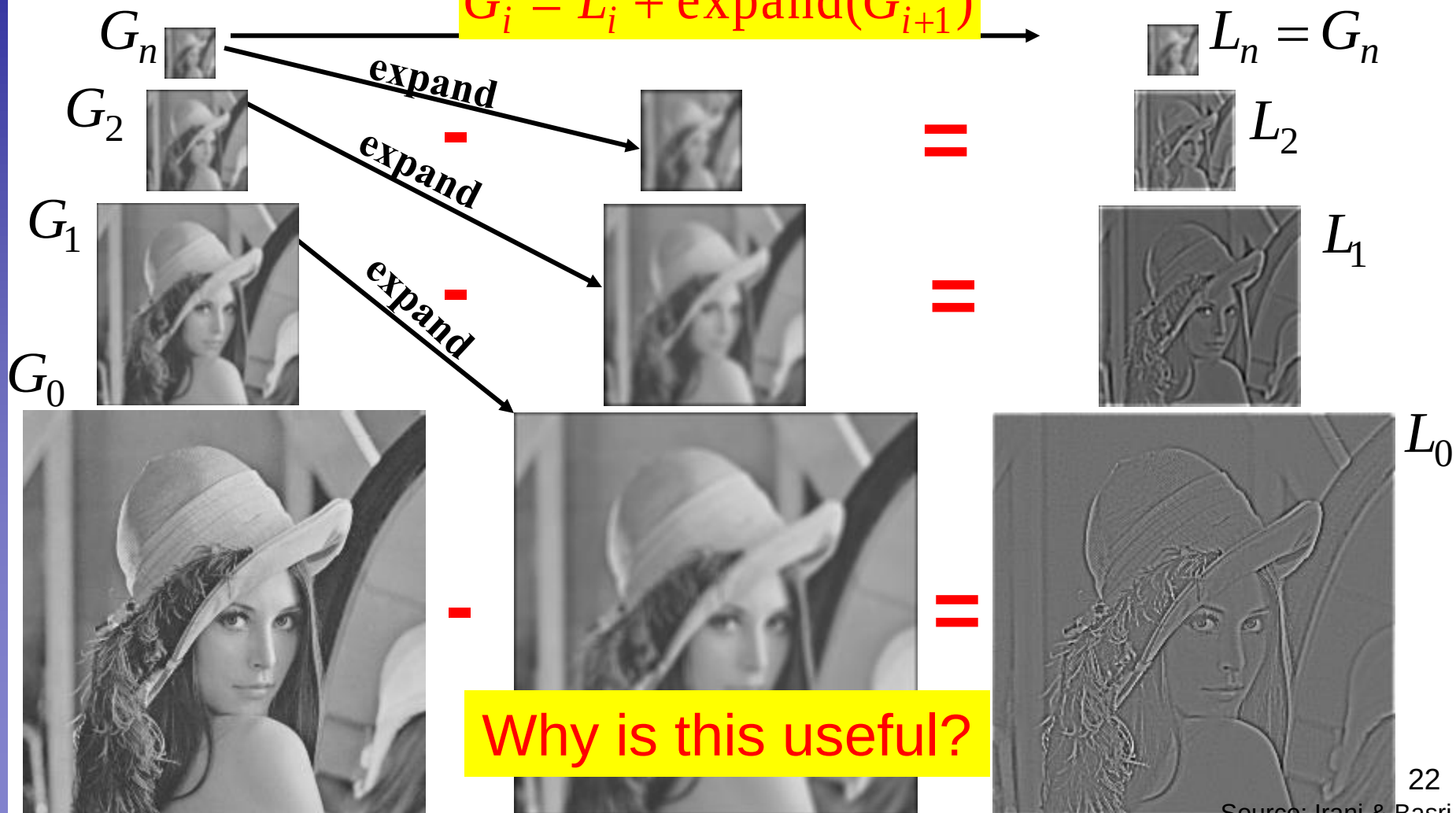
The Laplacian Pyramid

Gaussian Pyramid

$$L_i = G_i - \text{expand}(G_{i+1})$$

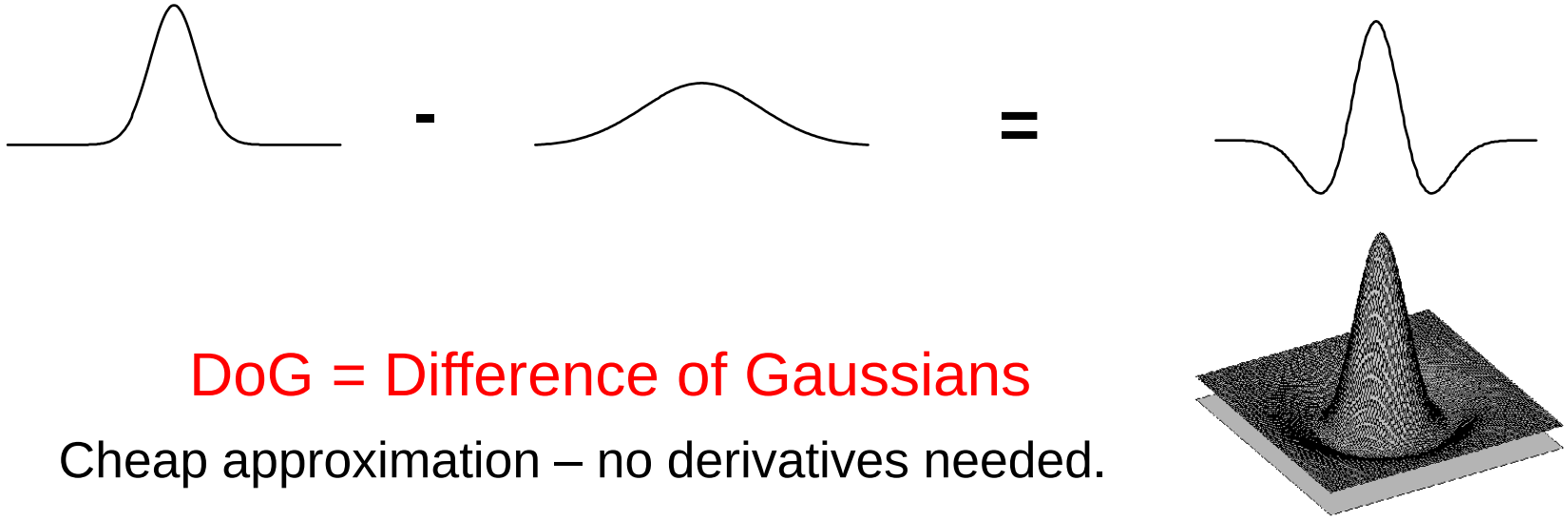
$$G_i = L_i + \text{expand}(G_{i+1})$$

Laplacian Pyramid



Why is this useful?

Laplacian ~ Difference of Gaussian



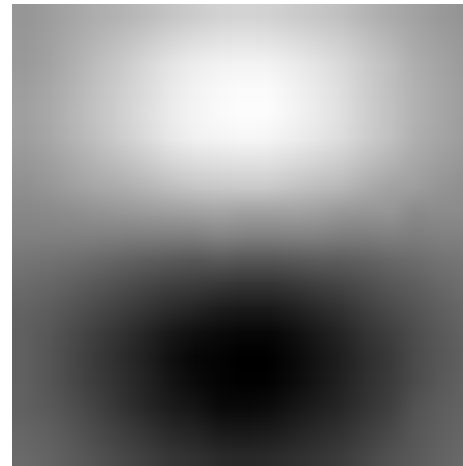
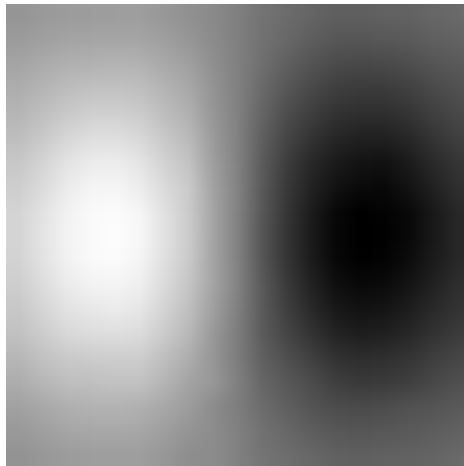
Topics of This Lecture

- Non-linear Filters
 - Median Filter
- Multi-Scale representations
 - How to properly rescale an image?
- **Filters as templates**
 - Correlation as template matching
- Image gradients
 - Derivatives of Gaussian



Note: Filters are Templates

- Applying a filter at some point can be seen as taking a dot-product between the image and some vector.
- Filtering the image is a set of dot products.
- Insight
 - Filters look like the effects they are intended to find.
 - Filters find effects they look like.



Where's Waldo?



Scene



Template

Where's Waldo?



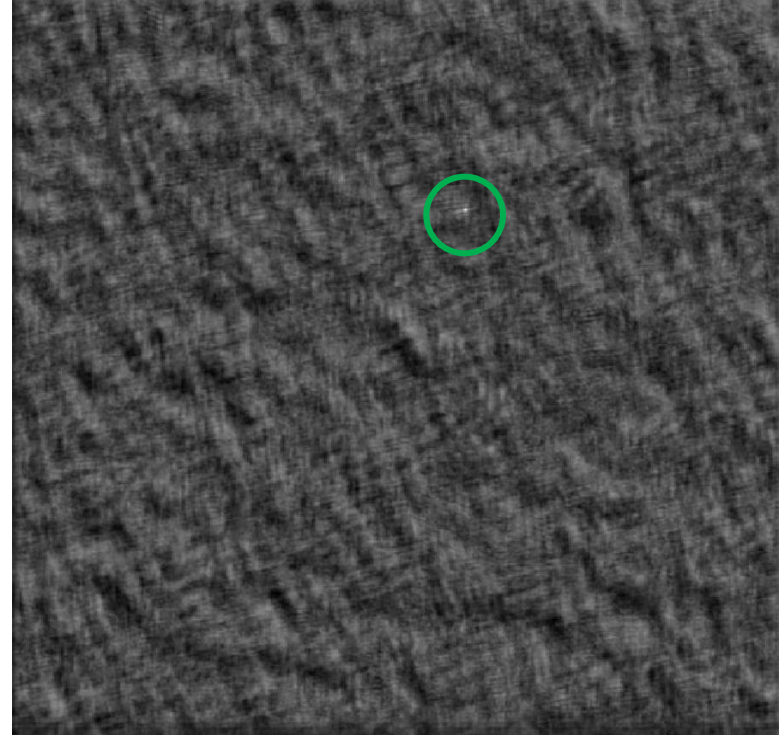
Template

Detected template

Where's Waldo?



Detected template



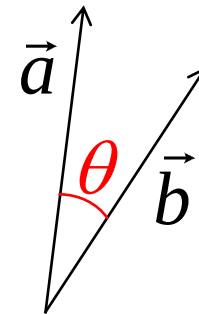
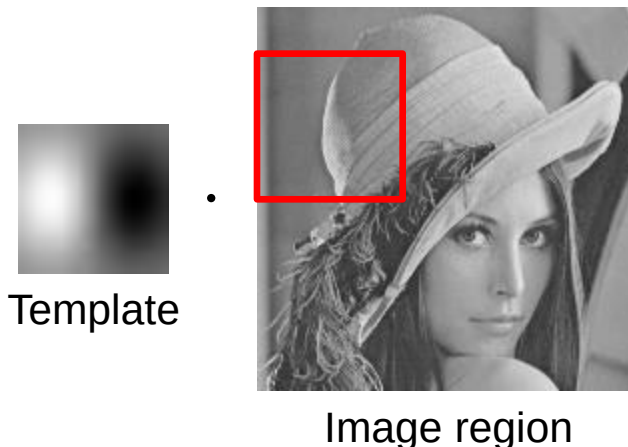
Correlation map

Correlation as Template Matching

- Think of filters as a dot product of the filter vector with the image region
 - Now measure the angle between the vectors

$$a \cdot b = |a| |b| \cos \theta \quad \cos \theta = \frac{a \cdot b}{|a| |b|}$$

- Angle (similarity) between vectors can be measured by normalizing the length of each vector to 1 and taking the dot product.



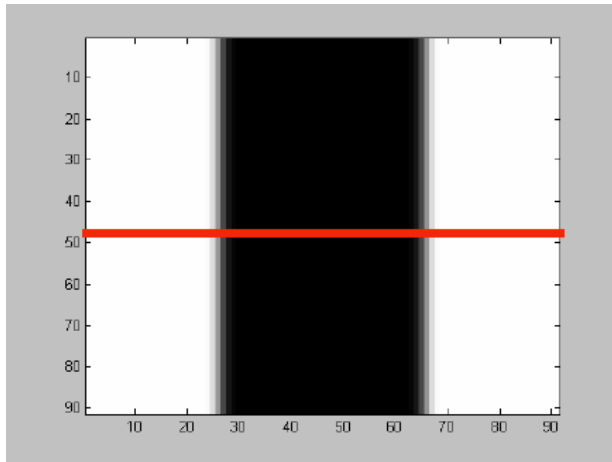
Vector interpretation

Topics of This Lecture

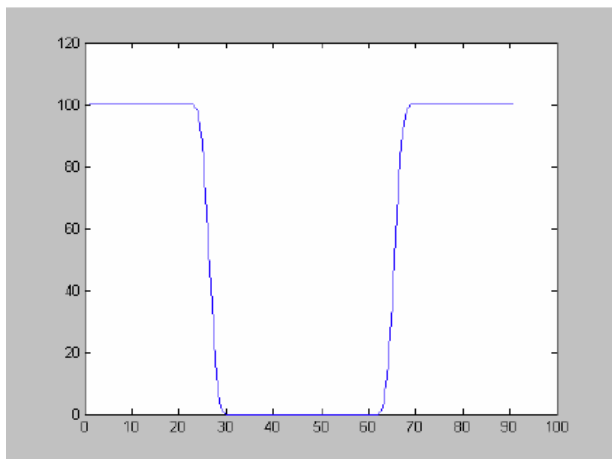
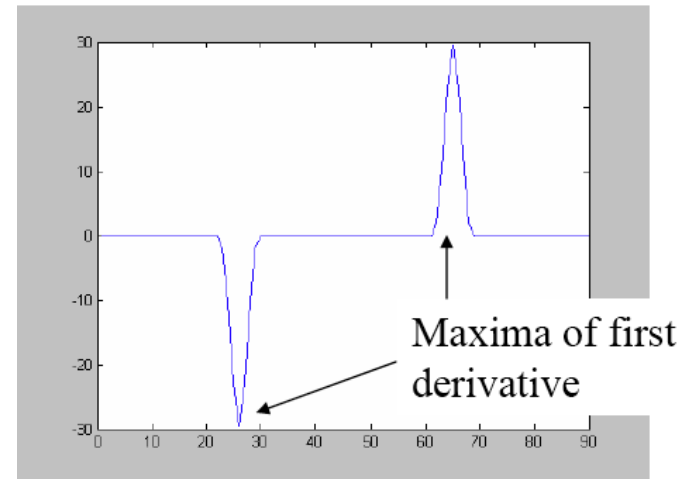
- Multi-Scale representations
 - How to properly rescale an image?
- Filters as templates
 - Correlation as template matching
- Image gradients
 - Derivatives of Gaussian



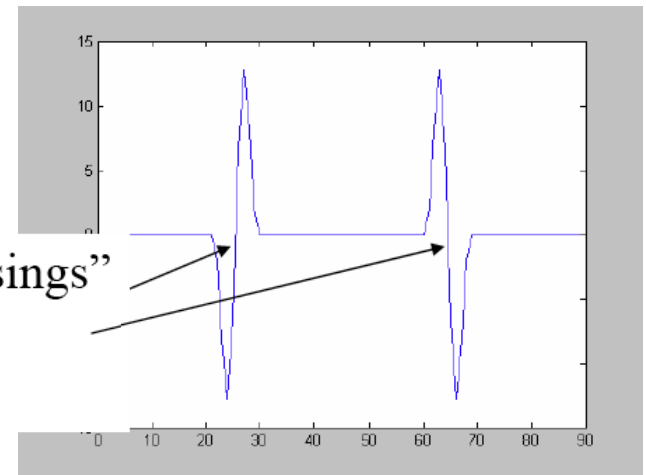
Derivatives and Edges...



1st derivative



2nd derivative



Differentiation and Convolution

- For the 2D function $f(x,y)$, the partial derivative is:

$$\frac{\partial f(x,y)}{\partial x} = \lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x+\varepsilon, y) - f(x, y)}{\varepsilon}$$

- For discrete data, we can approximate this using finite differences:

$$\frac{\partial f(x,y)}{\partial x} \approx \frac{f(x+1, y) - f(x, y)}{1}$$

- To implement the above as convolution, what would be the associated filter?

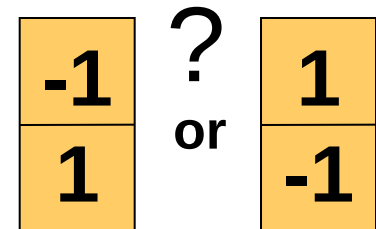
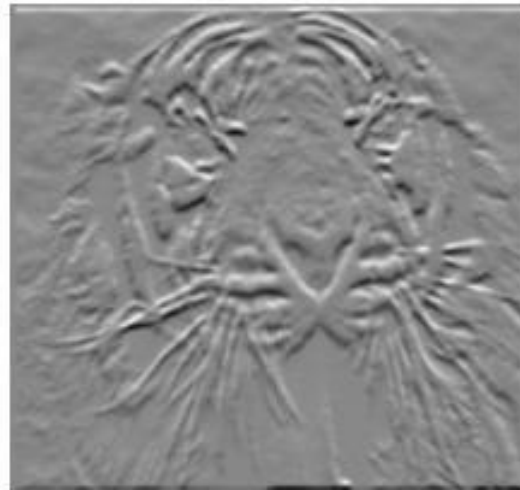
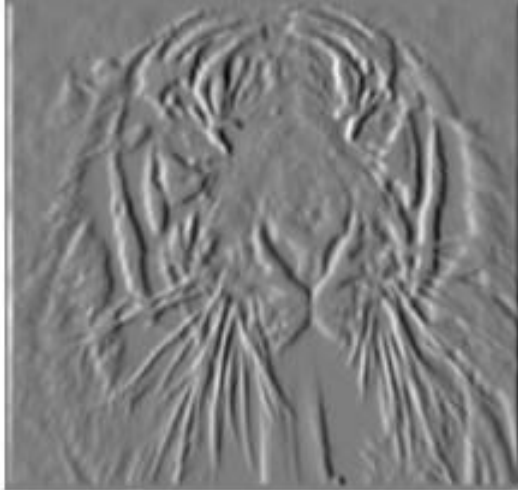
1	-1
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Partial Derivatives of an Image

$$\frac{\partial f(x, y)}{\partial x}$$



$$\frac{\partial f(x, y)}{\partial y}$$



Which one shows changes with respect to x?

Assorted Finite Difference Filters

Prewitt: $M_x = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$; $M_y = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$

Sobel: $M_x = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 & 1 \\ -2 & 0 & 2 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$; $M_y = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & -2 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$

Roberts: $M_x = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$; $M_y = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$

```
>> My = fspecial('sobel');  
>> outim = imfilter(double(im), My);  
>> imagesc(outim);  
>> colormap gray;
```

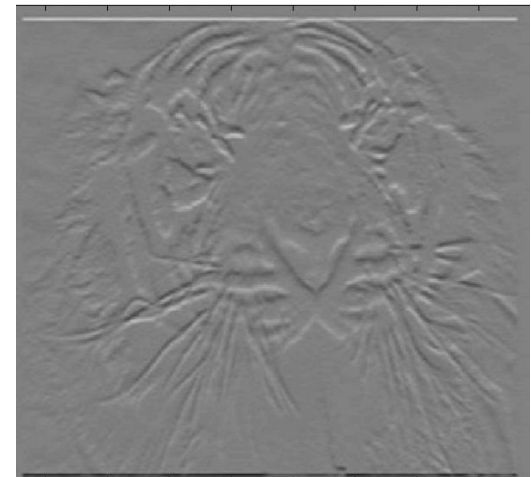
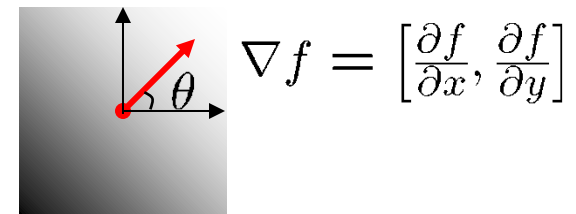
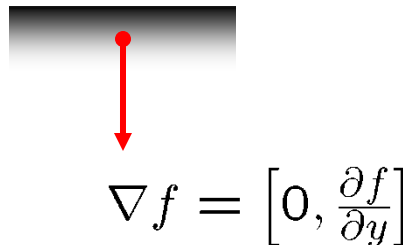
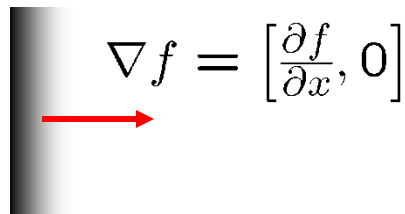


Image Gradient

- The gradient of an image:

$$\nabla f = \left[\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right]$$

- The gradient points in the direction of most rapid intensity change



- The gradient direction (orientation of edge normal) is given by:

$$\theta = \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} / \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \right)$$

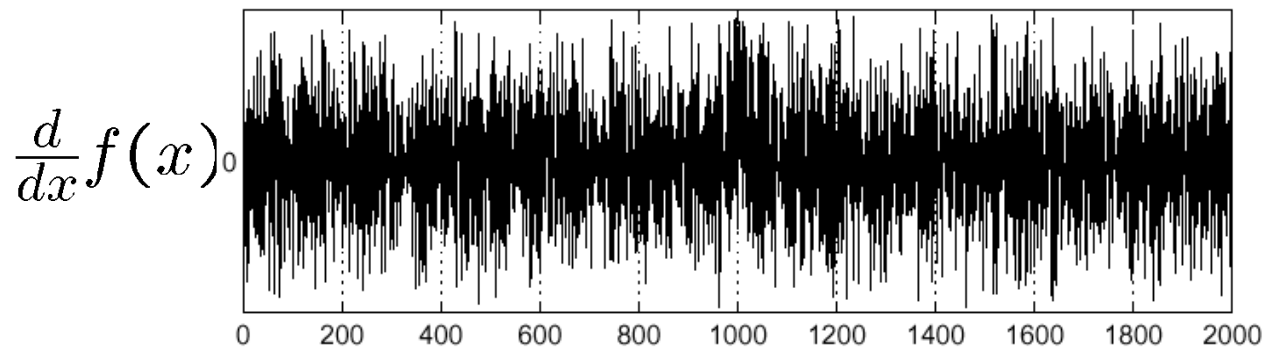
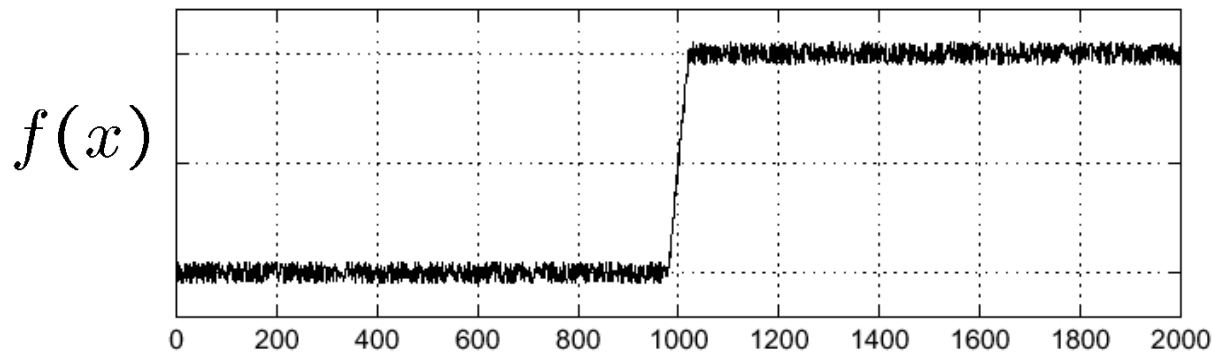
- The edge strength is given by the gradient magnitude

$$\|\nabla f\| = \sqrt{\left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \right)^2 + \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right)^2}$$



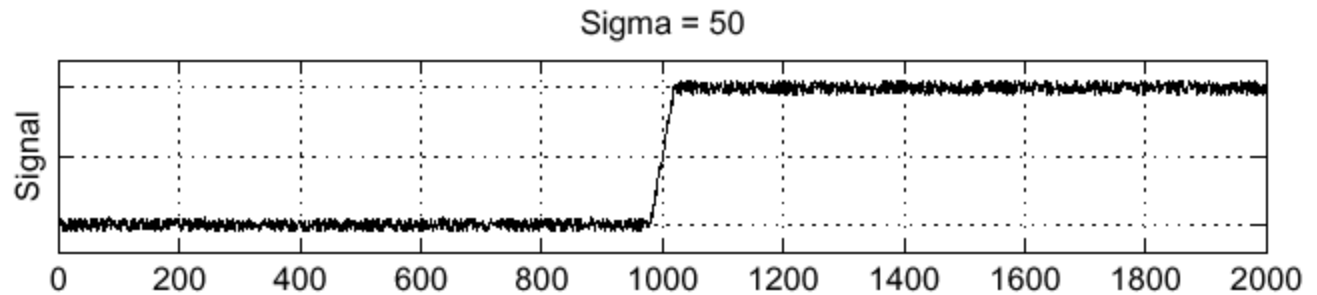
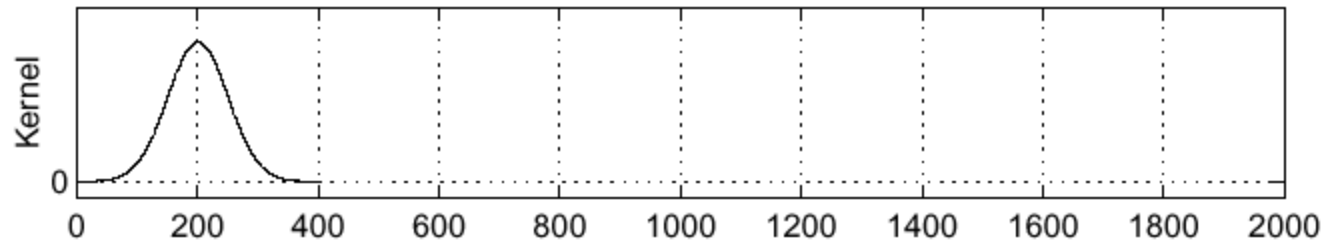
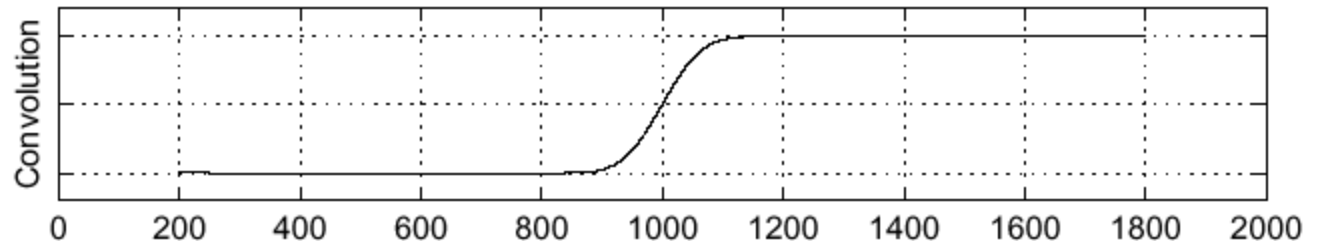
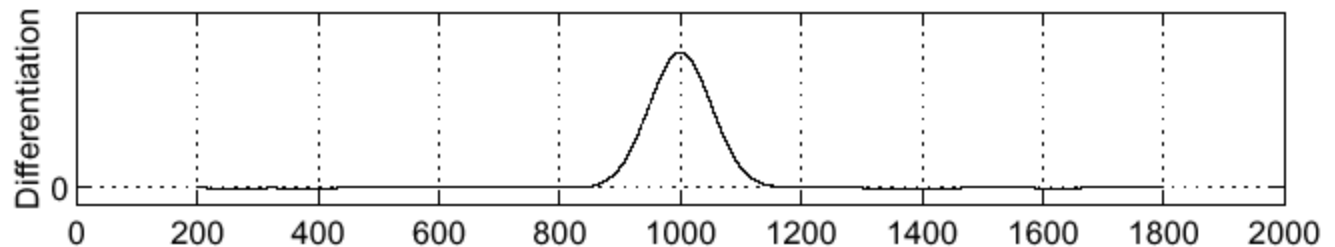
Effect of Noise

- Consider a single row or column of the image
 - Plotting intensity as a function of position gives a signal



Where is the edge?

Solution: Smooth First

 f

 h

 $h \star f$

 $\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(h \star f)$


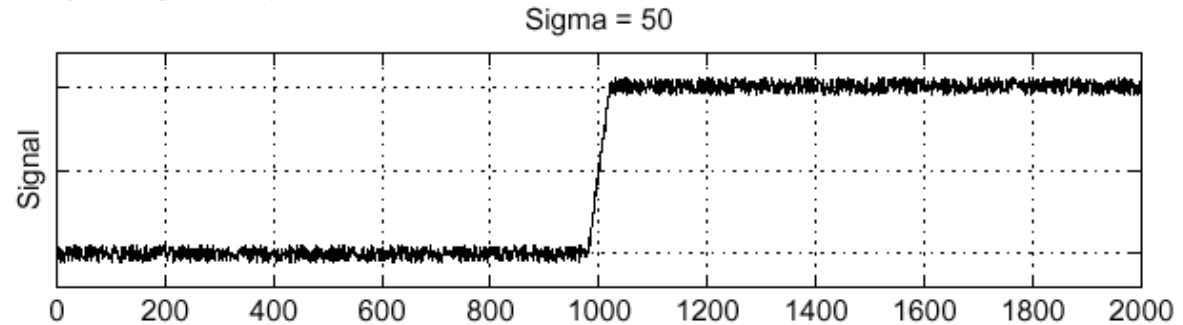
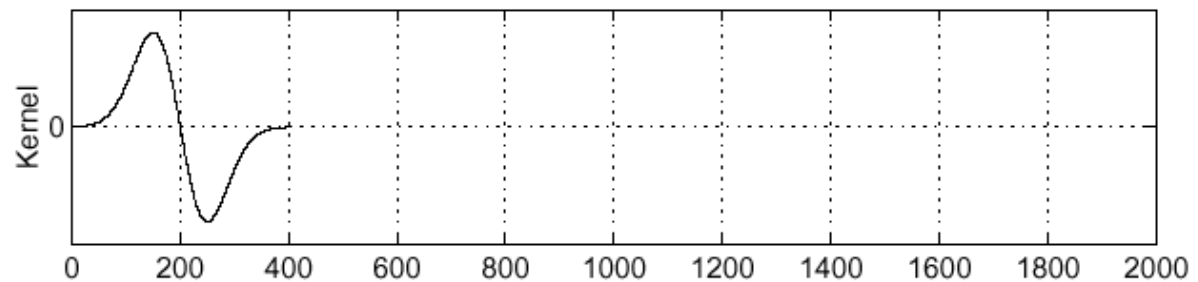
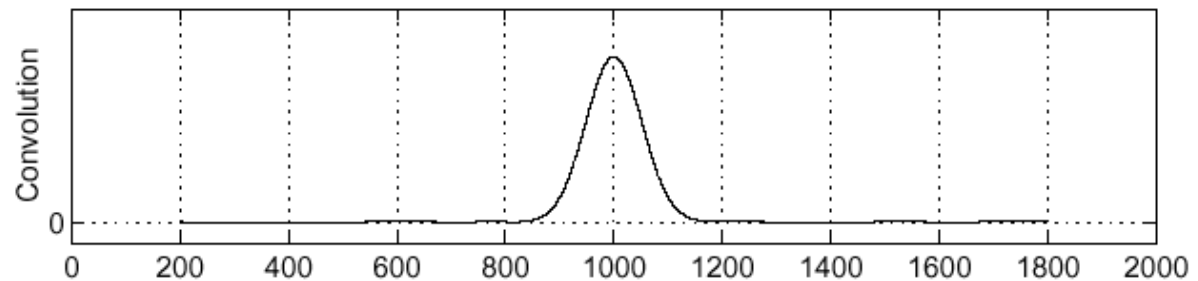
Where is the edge?

Look for peaks in $\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(h \star f)$

Derivative Theorem of Convolution

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(h \star f) = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x}h\right) \star f$$

- Differentiation property of convolution.

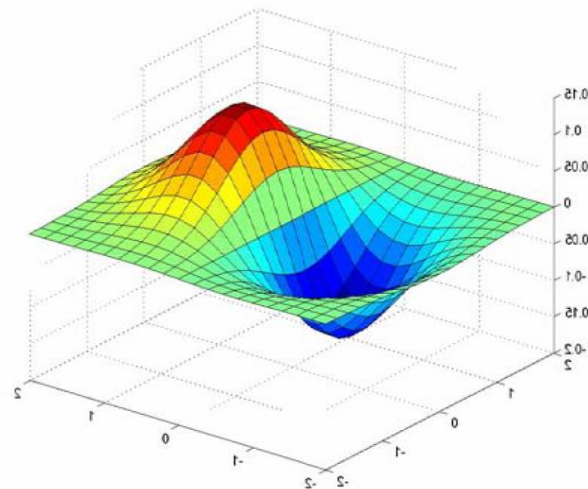
 f  $\frac{\partial}{\partial x}h$  $\left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x}h\right) \star f$ 

Derivative of Gaussian Filter

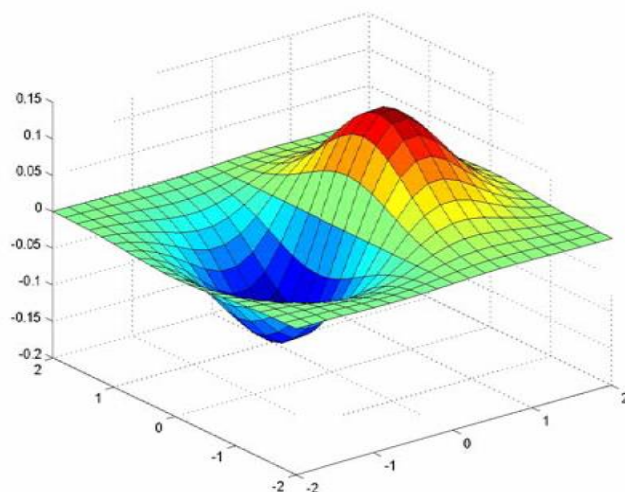
$$g * (h * I) = (g * h) * I$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \star \begin{bmatrix} 0.0030 & 0.0133 & 0.0219 & 0.0133 & 0.0030 \\ 0.0133 & 0.0596 & 0.0983 & 0.0596 & 0.0133 \\ 0.0219 & 0.0983 & 0.1621 & 0.0983 & 0.0219 \\ 0.0133 & 0.0596 & 0.0983 & 0.0596 & 0.0133 \\ 0.0030 & 0.0133 & 0.0219 & 0.0133 & 0.0030 \end{bmatrix}$$

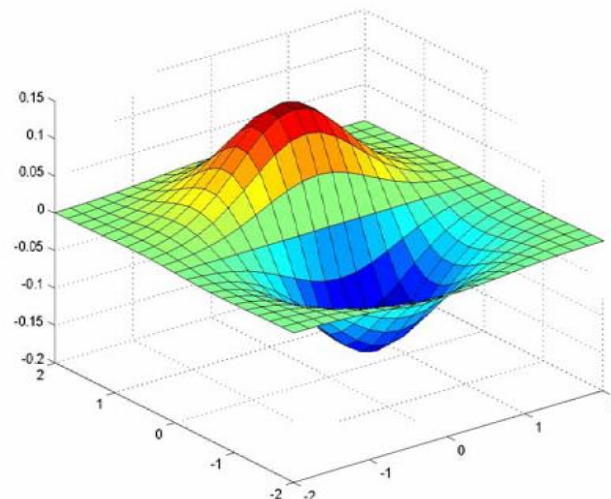
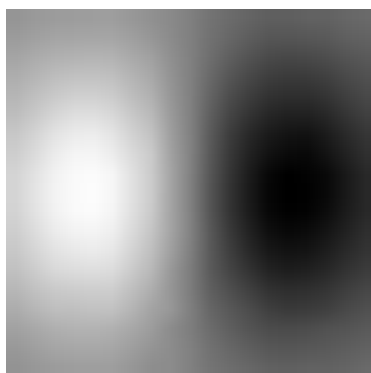
Why is this preferable?



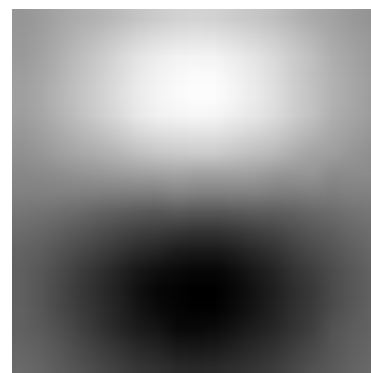
Derivative of Gaussian Filters



x-direction



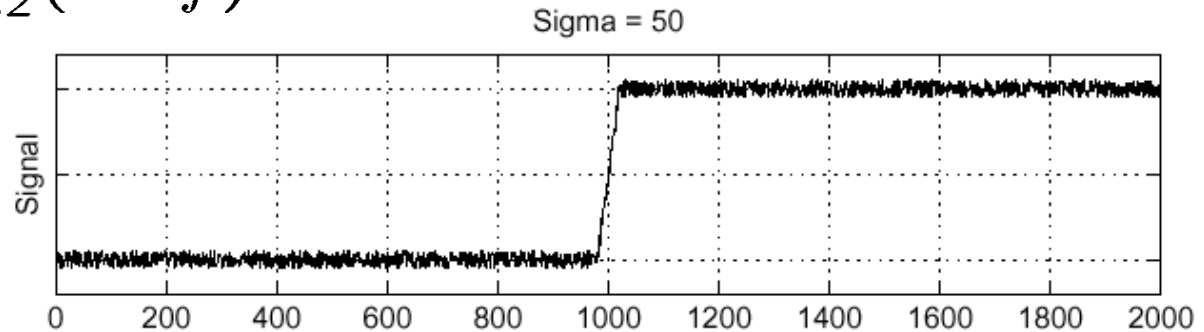
y-direction



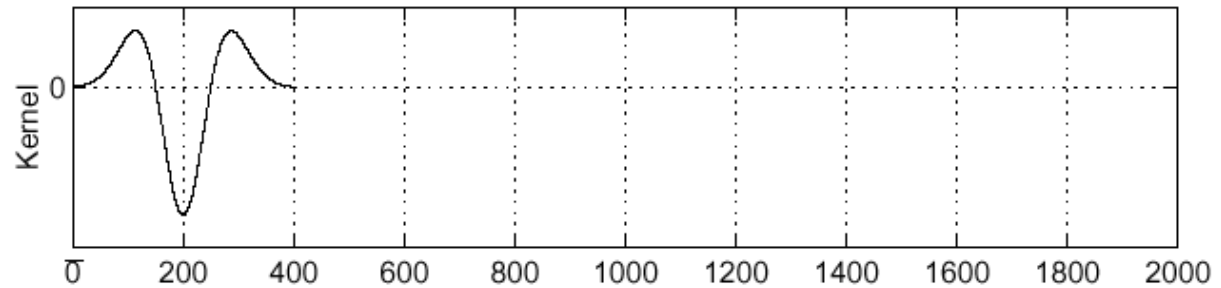
Laplacian of Gaussian (LoG)

- Consider $\frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}(h \star f)$

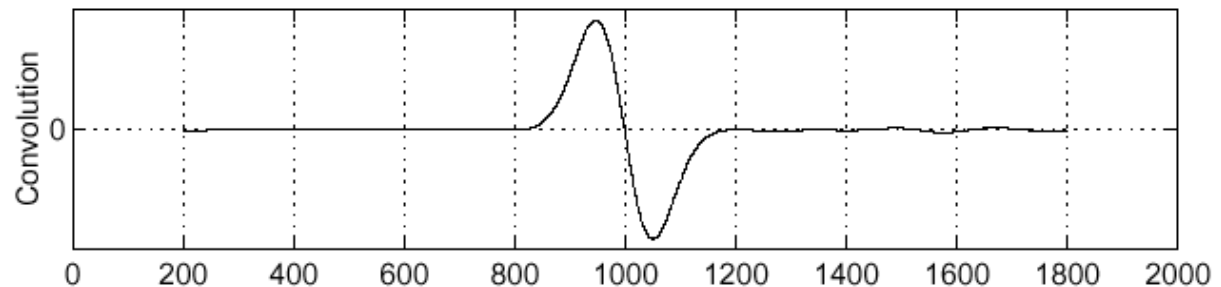
f



$\frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}h$



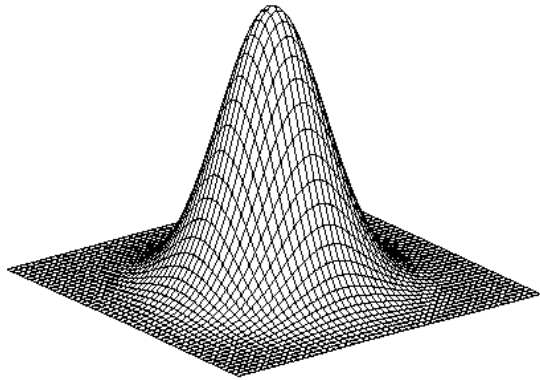
$(\frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}h) \star f$



Where is the edge?

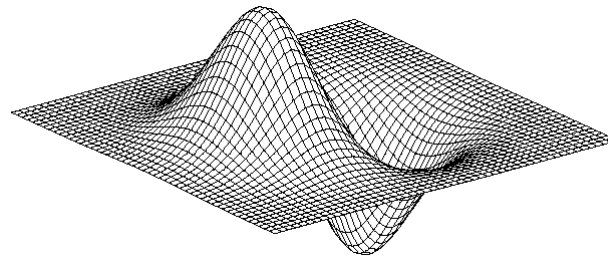
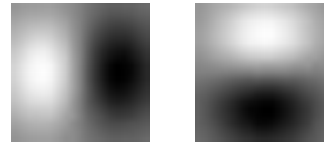
Zero-crossings of bottom graph

Summary: 2D Edge Detection Filters



Gaussian

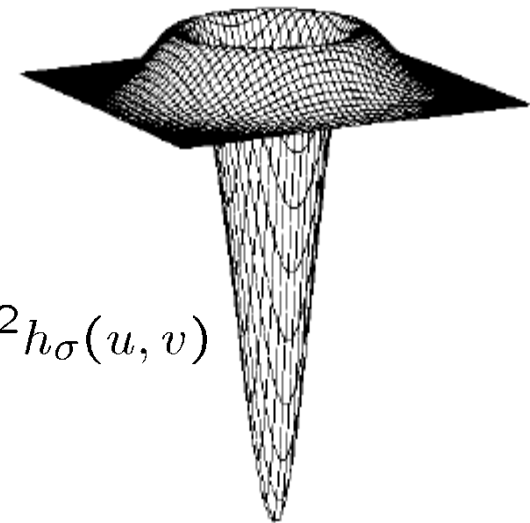
$$h_{\sigma}(u, v) = \frac{1}{2\pi\sigma^2} e^{-\frac{u^2+v^2}{2\sigma^2}}$$



Derivative of Gaussian

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} h_{\sigma}(u, v)$$

Laplacian of Gaussian



$$\nabla^2 h_{\sigma}(u, v)$$

- ∇^2 is the Laplacian operator:

$$\nabla^2 f = \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y^2}$$

References and Further Reading

- Background information on linear filters and image gradients can be found in Chapter 3 of the Szeliski book.

R. Szeliski
Computer Vision – Algorithms and Applications
Springer, 2010
([draft version available online](#))

